

Samsung SGH-A400

This phone has a very small form factor and weighs just 79.88 grams. It is aimed at the fairer sex and incorporates a host of features and functionality for women. In fact, at first glance it looks a lot like a woman's makeup compact! Featuring a flip-type construction, the 128x96 pixel four-greyscale screen measures just 1.34-inches diagonally but features some of the crispest and clearest graphics we have seen on a monochrome phone display. The animated screensavers here were especially impressive. Navigation is controlled through a circular button that takes some time getting used to and one has to press many buttons to reach a given setting. However, the screen icons and menu structure make it simple to understand the navigation after working with the phone for a while. There are a host of features such as reminders, To-do lists and a calendar that can be used to schedule appointments and meetings. The phone has a 99-entry

phonebook and there is also support for T9 predictive text entry for SMS. If you need to pass time, there are seven games included. However, the highlight of this phone is the added functionality for women. There is a separate section called 'Life' which contains functions that can be used to monitor and remind the user of various aspects pertaining to women's health. This includes a calorie monitor with entries that let you calculate how much energy you've burnt up while shopping, washing, jogging or even chattering!



Samsung SGH-A400		B+	Price: Rs 17,000
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Warranty	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		

+ Compact and light, impressive display, special features for women

- Takes many key presses to reach a given setting, flip-type construction is prone to breakage

Warranty and support

What happens when your cell phone goes on the blink? Cell phones have become an inseparable part of our lives and living without your cell phone can, indeed, prove to be very difficult. It is

therefore important that you get adequate and timely support from the vendor. Some of the indicative parameters that can assure you of good service are the number of service centres your phone manufacturer has around the country

and the number of cities in which these service centres are present. This means that you will always have access to technical assistance, even though you're on the road and on the move. The best option is if your vendor provides you with a standby phone while yours is being repaired.

Of all the phones we tested, the most service and warranty-friendly brand is Nokia. With a network of 56 authorised service centres in 41 cities across India, chances are that you are never going to be too far from help in case something happens to your Nokia phone while travelling. Nokia also provides a standby phone while your phone is being repaired so that you're always connected, and all their phones come with a one-year warranty.

Samsung holds the distinction of having the second largest network of authorised service centres with 50 authorised service centres in 28 cities across the country. Samsung also offers a one-year warranty on all its phones. Siemens follows close behind with 28 service centres in 28 cities across the country and it also offers a one-year warranty on all its phones.

Sony Ericsson T68i

The Sony Ericsson T68i is a marriage of bleeding-edge technology, highly intuitive usability and truly breathtaking looks. With its 1.63-inch, 256-colour screen and support for GPRS, Bluetooth and Infrared, this phone almost has it all. And all this in a package that weighs just 84.98 grams! This phone is very well styled and is very comfortable to hold. Navigation is made very simple by way of the tiny joystick that serves as both a navigation control as well as a select key. The most striking aspect of this device is the colour screen and the wealth of content that it allows, from static GIF images to animated MMS messages, screen-savers and even Web content. The phone even has themes that change the look and feel of the interface such as the background image, and the colour schemes of the icons and menu bars. The Bluetooth functionality lets it communicate with any such devices within a radius of 10 metres, allowing you to exchange data, surf the Internet or even take a printout without grappling with wires.



However, there are few downsides too—the present set of ring tones are exceedingly drab and really don't go with the phone's personality! Also, the GUI is rather heavy and some operations have a slight lag associated with them during navigation.

However, with unbeatable multimedia support, a brilliant display and support for a host of wireless technologies, this phone is the undisputed leader of the pack.

Sony Ericsson T68i		A	Price: Rs 28,000
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
Warranty	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶		

+ 256-colour screen; support for GPRS, Infrared and Bluetooth; intuitive control

- Drab ring tones, heavy (sometimes slow) GUI

And the winners are...

There's a wide range of cellular devices available in the market. Some stand out in terms of sheer performance while others offer tremendous functionality—there is something for everyone. Today's cellular phones far exceed the capabilities